

# Candela Lespada

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## EDUCATION

### Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, Business Minor

Expected May 2027

University of Maryland, College Park, MD

- Honors College: University Honors
- Relevant Coursework: Discrete Structures, Introduction to Computer Systems, Organization of Programming Languages, Algorithms, Programming Language Technologies and Paradigms, Accounting, Data Science

## PROGRAMMING EXPERIENCE

### Study Space Finder App - 'Sip & Study'

July 2026 - Current

- Designing a mobile app using Expo and React Native that lets users discover and rank cafes, libraries, and public workspaces based on study-friendly criteria like wifi quality, noise level, and outlet access, aimed at helping students and remote workers find suitable spots faster.

### Productivity App - 'Ganarlo'

May 2026 - Current

- Developing a habit-formation mobile app spanning 4 core flows - onboarding, task creation, screen-time reward tracking, and an iOS home-screen widget for at-a-glance progress - that rewards verified daily task completion with screen time.
- Designed the UI/UX in Figma and built the app using Expo and React Native, with Supabase powering the backend.

### Professor Rating Predictor

November 2025

- Built a transformer-based text classification model from scratch in PyTorch that predicts professor star ratings (1-5) from 633 student reviews pulled via the PlanetTerp API, achieving 75% exact-match accuracy and 88% accuracy within one star on a class-imbalanced dataset without relying on pretrained language models.

### MicroCaml Interpreter

July 2025

- Built a lexer, parser, and an interpreter for MicroCaml in OCaml. Applied functional programming concepts with OCaml features and validated correctness with unit tests.

### Automation Tool

April 2025

- Engineered a simplified UNIX make in C to parse custom makefiles and build targets with dependency rules. Wrote functions to add process control, dependency handling, valgrind checks to eliminate leaks, and an optimizer to ensure code efficiency.

## LEADERSHIP + WORK EXPERIENCE

### Chapter President, Alpha Chi Omega - Gamma Theta, College Park, MD

Nov. 2024 - Dec. 2025

- Lead and organize chapter meetings, events, and initiatives for 120+ members, including university-wide initiatives in community outreach, philanthropy, and membership engagement that foster a collaborative and inclusive environment.
- Oversee an executive board of 14 positions, help delegate responsibilities, and provide guidance to ensure successful execution of chapter programs, resulting in 20+ successful chapter programs per semester.
- Oversee and manage a budget of \$740,000 + strategically allocating funds to chapter operations, programming, and philanthropy while ensuring financial accountability.

### Assistant Swim Coach - Summer, Potomac Swim and Tennis, Potomac, MD

May 2024 - August 2025

- Designed and led 9-10 weekly practices for 90+ swimmers across beginner to advanced skill levels, adapting training techniques to individual development needs.
- Delivered one-on-one coaching on stroke efficiency, stamina, and race strategy, with nearly 100% of swimmers achieving personal best times.

## SKILLS AND CERTIFICATIONS

- Programming Languages: Java, JavaScript, C, Assembly, Python, OCaml, Rust, Pandas, HTML, CSS, SQL
- Leadership / Collaborative / Diligent / Proactive / Reliable / Problem-solver / Adaptable / Time Management
- Introduction to Data Science Landscape Certification
- AI in Business and Career Empowerment Certification
- Bilingual: English / Spanish